

| TELECOM TRUECALLER |

formation like address, website, email and business hours—like Google Maps does. It is also revamping its Truecaller Priority service to distinguish between valid business and spam calls. The company identifies calls based on colours. Blue is for standard, red means spam/scam/harassment while green are calls from a verified business and purple is a priority call that has use cases for companies that operate in e-commerce, cab hailing and other fields that need a user's immediate attention.

TRAI CALLING

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) has been asked by the Department of Telecommunications to develop a Truecaller-like caller identification service. According to experts, the service will display the caller's name based on the Know Your Customer information collected during the purchase of a SIM card, and will require a collaborative effort from all major telecom operators. Truecaller, however, does not see the development as a threat. "Based on the information available at present, we do not see this as a competitive service comparable to the full range of services that Truecaller offers. With our technology and data, Truecaller solves many more issues than a basic number identification service. We believe that the proposed TRAI development can even be a driving catalyst for our continued growth in India," Mamedì said in a statement.

For Jhunjhunwala, it's more like a validation of their product. "Our initial thought was that after more than a decade of being in the business, we actually got validation from a respected authority that this problem is worth going after. We're looking forward to the public consultation when it opens up. Over the years, we have moved further from just caller ID and spam detection and expanded our offerings. Those additions will help us continue to retain our market share," he says, adding, "Yet, I don't want to discount what TRAI is doing."

Amit Dubey, a Delhi-based cybercrime expert, however, feels that the Indian government's app will threaten the pole position of Truecaller since the majority of its use case is still caller ID and spam detection. "If the government takes up this initiative, it will be a threat for Truecaller. They will be able to give a better experience to users because of their integration with telecom companies and a bigger database,"



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ALAN MAMEDÌ

CEO AND CO-FOUNDER, TRUECALLER



"Philosophically, we want to make money from very transparent sources. We want to stay profitable so that our users don't think that these guys are one day going to get desperate and sell our data"

RISHIT JHUNJHUNWALA

CHIEF PRODUCT OFFICER & MD,
TRUECALLER INDIA